



GDD 17

Flip the Script

Spot it, flip it, call it out

The gender-stereotype game for ages 9-12, built to the mechanic-embodiment standard, and the strike-and-rewrite flagship. Children spot stereotypes hidden in everyday media, then flip the script, rewriting the message to a fair one, and learn to call it out. Seven mechanics, 29 flips, 14 media spot-checks, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Spot it, flip it, call it out.

Flip the Script is the gender-stereotype game, and the strike-and-rewrite flagship the strategy names by name. Children learn to spot stereotypes hidden in ads, films, songs and toys, then flip the script, rewriting the message to a fair one, and finally to call it out kindly in real life. It carries Fair Play World's fairness instinct (g10) into media literacy, the move at the heart of the whole gender thread. New v2 build to the standard.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g17 · flip-the-script (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 3 · ages 9-12 · light canvas · solo or peer
Thread / topics	E · Gender & Respect · UNESCO 3.1, 3.2, 1.3, 2.1, 2.2, 2.3, 5.4
Prerequisite / builds on	g16 (Crossroads) · builds on g10 (Fair Play World)
Gating	Core
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the strike-and-rewrite flagship.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

29

flips (UN→RE)

14

media spot-checks

0%

binary taps

The age the scripts get loud.

From the Chapter 3 personas. By 9-12, kids are soaking up gender scripts from feeds, films and family, this game hands them the tools to question and flip them.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Aarav, 12 (absorbing "real men don't cry")	To unlearn the "be a man, hide feelings" script.	strike-rewrite + role-play : flip "man up".
Diya, 11 ("is this fair?")	To name and challenge "girls can't / shouldn't".	strike-rewrite + branch : flip "girls stay home".
Asha, 24 (peer educator)	To model calling out unfairness, kindly.	strike-rewrite : speaking up isn't rude.
Rohit (father)	The "men don't cook / do housework" script flipped.	strike-rewrite : fair partners share it.
Every child	A media radar for the stereotypes around them.	spot + sort : catch it on screen.

Why this works (the evidence). Gender stereotypes are learned, and a lot of the teaching comes from media, ads, films, songs, toys. They can be spotted and questioned. Roles, jobs, traits, colours and feelings aren't owned by one gender, and counter-examples are everywhere. Media-literacy practice plus "flip it" rehearsal, rewriting a stereotyped message into a fair one, builds the lasting habit of challenging bias.

Seven moves, led by the flip.

The rework's heart: gender equality arrives through seven actions, and this is the game where **strike-rewrite** rightly leads, the strategy lists Flip the Script as a flagship of the strike-and-rewrite (UN/RE) signature. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE CHILD DOES	EMBODIES	N
strike-rewrite (the flip) signature	Erases a stereotype and writes the fair truth ("boys don't cry" → "everyone cries").	Conceptual change, the core "flip".	29
spot	Finds the stereotype hidden in an ad, film, song or shop.	Media literacy.	14
reflect	Considers their own freedom, dreams and feelings beyond the script.	Self-application.	12
branch	Decides what to do when a stereotype shows up around them.	Acting on fairness.	10
role-play (voice)	Says the flip out loud, "games don't have a gender, deal me in".	Assertion; calling it out.	9
sort	Sorts stereotype vs fact; made-up rule vs real reason.	Telling bias from truth.	7
match	Pairs a role to a real person who breaks the mould.	Counter-examples.	3

29 flips and **14 spot-checks** carry the game. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it fun?

Flip the Script plays like a media-detective game with a remix twist: you scan a real-feeling ad or film clip for the sneaky stereotype, tap it, then get to flip the message, swapping "every mother wants a clean home" for "every family keeps it clean together". The "spot the trick, then remix it" loop is satisfying and a little cheeky, exactly the playful energy the strategy wants, and it makes calling things out feel like winning, not lecturing.

Is it teaching?

Yes, media literacy plus gender equality: that stereotypes are learned (often from screens), that no role, trait, colour or feeling belongs to one gender, and that anyone can spot, flip and respectfully call out bias.

The belief it moves. From "what I see on screen is just how things are; boys don't cry; girls can't; pink is for girls; calling it out is rude" → "media repeats made-up scripts, I can spot them, flip them to something fair, and speak up, kindly, when I see them."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the spot → flip → call-it-out arc, grounded in real Indian media and everyday life. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Spot the stereotype	16	spot, reflect, sort	Ads, films, toys, songs, shops, defaults, what a stereotype is.
Any job, any role	14	sort, strike-rewrite, match	Pilots, nurses, chefs, scientists, leaders, chores, role models.
Feelings & strength	16	strike-rewrite, branch, role-play	"Boys don't cry", "like a girl", girls can lead and be angry.
Colours, clothes & stuff	12	strike-rewrite, sort, spot	Pink/blue, hair, dresses, dolls, made-up rules vs real reasons.
Flip the script	14	strike-rewrite, branch, role-play	Remix a stereotyped message; rewrite stories & ads; self-check.
Call it out & remix it	12	role-play, branch, strike-rewrite	Speak up kindly, with peers, elders, online; allyship.

A spot scenario (spot the stereotype), verbatim.

```
hook: "An ad for a cleaning product. Spot the stereotype."
scene  "A smiling mum scrubs the floor while the family relaxes" [trick]
scene  "Gets out tough stains"
scene  "The voice says 'every mother wants a clean home'" [trick]
why: "Ads often show only women doing the cleaning, as if it's only their job."
```

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 17 Flip the Script — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

SCRIPT (UN ERASES)	FLIP (RE WRITES)	BASIS
Real boys don't cry.	Everyone cries; it's healthy, not weak.	Emotions / gender.
'Like a girl' means weak.	'Like a girl' can mean strong, fast and skilled.	Language / gender.
Flying planes is a man's job.	Women fly too; India has one of the world's highest shares of women pilots.	Jobs / India fact.
Cooking is women's work.	Anyone can cook; many top chefs are men, and dads cook too.	Chores / jobs.
Girls are too emotional to lead.	Understanding emotions makes a better leader.	Leadership.
Pink is for girls, blue for boys.	Colours are for everyone; pink was once a 'boy' colour.	Colours / history.
Real men don't do housework.	Sharing housework is what fair partners do.	Chores / fairness.
Calling out a stereotype is rude.	Questioning unfairness, kindly, is fair and brave.	Voice / values.

The micro-loop.

1. **Hook.** Lensy: "something's off in this ad, can you spot it?".
2. **Play.** Spot the stereotype, or flip one, or sort fact from bias, rotated.
3. **The flip.** On a stereotype, UN strikes it through and RE rewrites the fair version, the signature beat.
4. **Apply.** Remix an ad/story, or say the call-it-out line in a role-play.
5. **Reflect.** "What's a job you'd love? Your gender doesn't stop you."
6. **Sticker.** The Script-Flipper badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **strike-and-rewrite card**, the stereotype struck through, the fair line written in, paired here with a **spot-the-trick** media frame. This is the reference implementation the whole gender thread (MythBuster Gender, Equalize, Norm Storm) reuses.

Question, don't preach.

- **Register.** Ages 9-12, matter-of-fact and near-peer; Lensy invites questioning, never hands down a lecture.
- **Respectful of culture.** Flips of family and tradition are modelled respectfully ("is this fair, na?"), so children can question without attacking elders.
- **No one's the villain.** Stereotypes are framed as learned scripts to flip, not as proof that a person is bad.
- **All genders freed.** The game flips boy-scripts and girl-scripts equally, "boys can cry" sits beside "girls can lead".
- **Safe to call out.** Role-plays model kind, doable lines, and "one voice can spark others" so speaking up feels possible.
- **Access.** Audio-first, offline; India-grounded media examples; pairs with Fair Play World (g10).

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. flip-the-script** — node.game === GameDone key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema**. Each scenario carries type + typed payload; the **strike-rewrite** renderer (myth: un / re / why) is the signature, with the **spot** renderer (scene + trick flags + why) doing the media-literacy work.
- **Scorecard-gated**. Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, strike-rewrite at the 35% cap, 0% binary, 19 autonomy, 29 UN→RE, 5 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Reuse**. The flip and spot renderers are shared with MythBuster Gender (g25), Equalize (g26), Smart Screen Heroes (g12) and Norm Storm (g18), build once, reuse across the thread.
- **Generated path**. Label/order/thread changes flow through the xlsx + gen-path, never hand-edited path.ts.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): question not preach; respect culture while flipping it; no person is the villain; free all genders equally; make calling-out kind and doable; made-for-India media.

Why this works.

- **Stereotypes are learned, often from media.** Ads, films, songs and toys repeat gender scripts, so a media-literacy game that trains kids to spot them targets the actual source of the learning.
- **Counter-examples are everywhere.** Women pilots and boxers, men chefs and nurses, dads who cook, the truth that no role or trait is owned by a gender is best taught with real, nameable examples, which the match and strike-rewrite scenarios supply.
- **Flipping builds the habit.** Actively rewriting a stereotyped message into a fair one (not just spotting it) is what turns awareness into a durable bias-challenging habit, so the game is flip-led and ends on calling it out.

Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 19 games now v2. Next in Chapter 3: Norm Storm (g18, where do norms come from).